The Shoah (1933–1945)

KNOWLEDGE RETRIEVAL & HOMEWORK COMPANION • 30 HIGH-YIELD QUESTIONS

Pupil Name: _____ **Class:** _____ **Teacher:** _____



The Shoah (1933–1945) • The state-sponsored, systematic persecution and murder of six million Jewish people by the Nazi regime and its collaborators across occupied Europe.

LESSON ENQUIRY FOCUS	HW DUE DATE	1. SOLO (WRITTEN)	2. PARTNER (VERBAL)	PARENT / TEACHER SIGN
Enquiry 1: Pre-War Life & Persecution 9.5 million European Jews, Ashkenazi/Sephardi diversity, 1933 boycott, 1935 Nuremberg Laws & November 1938 Kristallnacht pogrom		/ 6	/ 6	
Enquiry 2: Invasion & Ghettoisation 1939 Invasion of Poland, 3 million Polish Jews, yellow star badges, sealed Warsaw Ghetto, smuggling & Oyneg Shabes archive		/ 6	/ 6	
Enquiry 3: Barbarossa & Einsatzgruppen Operation Barbarossa, ideological war of annihilation, Einsatzgruppen death squads, Babi Yar ravine & transition to gas vans		/ 6	/ 6	
Enquiry 4: Final Solution & Resistance 1942 Wannsee Conference (Heydrich), Operation Reinhard (Treblinka, Sobibor), Auschwitz-Birkenau, Zyklon B & Warsaw Ghetto Uprising		/ 6	/ 6	
Enquiry 5: Rescuers, Liberation & Legacy Righteous Among the Nations (Wallenberg, Sugihara), death marches, liberation of Auschwitz/Belsen, Nuremberg Trials & Raphael Lemkin		/ 6	/ 6	

HOW TO COMPLETE YOUR RETRIEVAL CYCLES:

1. SOLO (WRITTEN): Complete your 6 write-in lines from memory without looking. Check your answers in green pen using the Department Marking Bank on Pages 7–8.

2. PARTNER (VERBAL): Hand your booklet to a **PARENT, CARER, FAMILY MEMBER, OR STUDY BUDDY** to test you out loud from the Marking Bank until you hit 6/6!

Scan for Interactive Digital Quizzes & Audio Lessons:
Access online self-marking retrieval flashcards, diagnostic feedback, and audio narration at the-history-revision-hub.netlify.app.

Enquiry 1: Pre-War Life & Persecution

Who were the Jews of Europe, and how did Nazi policy strip their rights (1933–1939)?

QUESTIONS 1–6

1920s 9.5m European Jews → **Jan 1933** Hitler Becomes Chancellor → **Apr 1933** Anti-Jewish Boycott → **Sept 1935** Nuremberg Laws Passed → **Nov 1938** Kristallnacht Pogrom

1. Approximately how many Jewish people lived in Europe prior to the Second World War in 1933?

Fact: _____

Explanation: _____

2. What was the core distinction between medieval religious anti-Judaism and Nazi racial antisemitism?

Fact: _____

Explanation: _____

3. How did the linguistic and cultural traditions of Ashkenazi Jewry shape Eastern European Jewish life?

Fact: _____

Explanation: _____

4. Why did the Nazi regime launch a nationwide boycott of Jewish businesses on 1 April 1933?

Fact: _____

Explanation: _____

5. How did the 1935 Nuremberg Laws legally strip German Jews of their basic human and civil rights?

Fact: _____

Explanation: _____

6. Why was the nationwide pogrom of "Kristallnacht" in November 1938 a decisive turning point in Nazi policy?

Fact: _____

Explanation: _____

KEY TERM VAULT: Shoah | Antisemitism | Ashkenazi | Yiddish | Nuremberg Laws | Kristallnacht

Enquiry 2: Invasion & Ghettoisation

How did the outbreak of WWII transform Nazi anti-Jewish policy and lead to ghettoisation?

QUESTIONS 7–12

Sept 1939 Invasion of Poland → Nov 1939 Star of David Mandated → Oct 1940 Warsaw Ghetto Sealed → 1940–42 Ghetto Starvation & Dise… → 1940–43 Oyneg Shabes Archive B…

7. How did the German invasion of Poland on 1 September 1939 radically transform the scale of Nazi persecution?

Fact: _____

Explanation: _____

8. Which visual marker were all Jewish people forced to wear in occupied Poland from November 1939?

Fact: _____

Explanation: _____

9. What conditions characterised life inside the sealed Warsaw Ghetto, the largest ghetto in occupied Europe?

Fact: _____

Explanation: _____

10. How did child smugglers play a heroic, life-saving role in the daily survival of the ghettos?

Fact: _____

Explanation: _____

11. What was the purpose of the secret "Oyneg Shabes" archive organized by historian Emanuel Ringelblum?

Fact: _____

Explanation: _____

12. What agonising dilemma confronted the Jewish Councils (Judenräte) appointed to run the ghettos?

Fact: _____

Explanation: _____

KEY TERM VAULT: Invasion of Poland | Yellow Star | Warsaw Ghetto | Judenrat | Oyneg Shabes | Ringelblum

Enquiry 3: Barbarossa & Einsatzgruppen

How and why did anti-Jewish persecution turn into systematic mass murder (1941–1942)?

QUESTIONS 13–18

June 1941 Operation Barbarossa → July 1941 Einsatzgruppen Deploy → Sept 1941 Babi Yar Massacre (33,7… → Dec 1941 Chelmno Gas Vans Open → 1941–43 1.5m Shot in USSR

13. ► **What was Operation Barbarossa, launched by Nazi Germany on 22 June 1941?**

Fact: _____

Explanation: _____

14. ► **Who were the Einsatzgruppen, following directly behind advancing German army units in 1941?**

Fact: _____

Explanation: _____

15. ►► **What took place at the ravine of Babi Yar outside Kiev on 29–30 September 1941?**

Fact: _____

Explanation: _____

16. ►► **Why did Nazi leadership decide to transition from mass shootings to mobile gas vans and industrial chambers?**

Fact: _____

Explanation: _____

17. ►►► **What role did local collaborator police auxiliaries play in facilitating the "Holocaust by Bullets" in the East?**

Fact: _____

Explanation: _____

18. ►►► **Why do historians describe the summer of 1941 as the pivotal turning point towards the "Final Solution"?**

Fact: _____

Explanation: _____

KEY TERM VAULT: Operation Barbarossa | Einsatzgruppen | Babi Yar | Holocaust by Bullets | Gas Vans | Chelmno

Jan 1942 Wannsee Conference → **1942** Operation Reinhard Camps → **Apr 1943** Warsaw Ghetto Uprising → **Oct 1943** Sobibor Camp Revolt → **Oct 1944** Auschwitz Sonderkomm...

19. ► **What was the purpose of the Wannsee Conference convened by Reinhard Heydrich on 20 January 1942?**

Fact: _____

Explanation: _____

20. ► **Which three dedicated extermination camps were constructed in 1942 under Operation Reinhard in Poland?**

Fact: _____

Explanation: _____

21. ►► **How did Auschwitz-Birkenau operate as both a concentration labour camp and an industrial death centre?**

Fact: _____

Explanation: _____

22. ►► **What took place during the heroic Warsaw Ghetto Uprising in April–May 1943?**

Fact: _____

Explanation: _____

23. ►►► **How did prisoners in extermination camps like Treblinka and Sobibor organise armed uprisings?**

Fact: _____

Explanation: _____

24. ►►► **Who were the Bielski partisans and how did their armed forest community redefine Jewish resistance?**

Fact: _____

Explanation: _____

KEY TERM VAULT: Wannsee Conference | Final Solution | Operation Reinhard | Treblinka | Auschwitz-Birkenau | Zyklon B

Enquiry 5: Rescuers, Liberation & Legacy

Who tried to save, what did liberation reveal, and how did Nuremberg establish crimes against humanity?

QUESTIONS 25–30

1944 Wallenberg Saves Budap… → Jan 1945 Auschwitz Liberated → Apr 1945 Bergen-Belsen Liberated → Nov 1945 Nuremberg Trials Open → 1948 UN Genocide Convention

25. ► **What term was created by Yad Vashem to honour non-Jewish individuals who risked their lives to rescue Jews?**

Fact: _____

Explanation: _____

26. ► **Why did the SS force tens of thousands of starving prisoners on brutal "Death Marches" in winter 1944–1945?**

Fact: _____

Explanation: _____

27. ►► **What horrifying conditions did British troops discover when liberating Bergen-Belsen in April 1945?**

Fact: _____

Explanation: _____

28. ►► **What total number of Jewish lives were murdered by the Nazi regime and its collaborators during the Shoah?**

Fact: _____

Explanation: _____

29. ►►► **How did the 1945–1946 Nuremberg Trials establish a revolutionary precedent in international criminal law?**

Fact: _____

Explanation: _____

30. ►►► **Who coined the legal term "Genocide" in 1944, and why was a new word required to define the Shoah?**

Fact: _____

Explanation: _____

KEY TERM VAULT: Righteous Among the Nations | Death Marches | Liberation 1945 | Bergen-Belsen | Nuremberg Trials | Genocide (Lemkin)

Department Marking Bank • Part 1

Green-Pen Verification Key • Enquiries 1 to 3 (Questions 1 to 18)

ENQUIRIES 1–3

ENQUIRY 1: PRE-WAR LIFE & PERSECUTION

1. ► **Approximately 9.5 million Jewish people lived across Europe** — *Jews formed vibrant communities from rural shtetls in Poland to integrated professionals in Berlin, Paris, and Vienna.* [✓] [✗]

2. ► **Medieval prejudice targeted religious belief; Nazi antisemitism targeted biological race** — *Medieval victims could escape persecution through Christian baptism; Nazi racial ideology defined Jewishness as an unalterable genetic identity.* [✓] [✗]

3. ►► **Through the shared Yiddish language, religious scholarship, and market town communities** — *Over 5 million Jews in Eastern Europe spoke Yiddish, producing world-renowned literature, theater, and tight-knit communal life.* [✓] [✗]

4. ►► **To intimidate Jewish citizens and test public acceptance of overt state economic persecution** — *SA stormtroopers picketed Jewish shops; widespread public passivity encouraged Hitler to formalize legal anti-Jewish discrimination.* [✓] [✗]

5. ►►► **By revoking German citizenship and banning marriage between Jews and non-Jewish Germans** — *The Reich Citizenship Law reduced Jews to second-class subjects, while the Blood Protection Law criminalised intermarriage under racial pseudo-science.* [✓] [✗]

6. ►►► **It marked the shift from legal discrimination to coordinated state violence and mass arrests** — *Over 90 Jews were murdered, 1,000 synagogues burned, and 30,000 men sent to concentration camps, destroying illusions of survival in Germany.* [✓] [✗]

ENQUIRY 2: INVASION & GHETTOISATION

7. ► **It brought over 3 million Polish Jews under brutal Nazi military and SS control** — *Before 1939, Nazi policy sought forced emigration; conquering Poland created an immense population the Nazis sought to isolate and exploit.* [✓] [✗]

8. ► **A white armband with a blue Star of David, later standardised as a yellow star** — *The badge marked Jews for public humiliation, physical assault, forced labour roundups, and severe travel restrictions under pain of death.* [✓] [✗]

9. ►► **Extreme overcrowding, starvation rations under 300 calories a day, and raging typhus** — *Over 400,000 people were crammed into 1.3 square miles behind 10-foot brick walls; over 80,000 died of hunger before deportations began.* [✓] [✗]

10. ►► **By slipping through drainage pipes, holes in walls, and sewers to smuggle food inside** — *Children risked being shot on sight by SS guards to bring potatoes and flour back to their starving families inside the walls.* [✓] [✗]

11. ►►► **To document the truth of ghetto life, Nazi atrocities, and Jewish cultural resistance** — *Ringelblum collected essays, diaries, and underground newspapers, burying them in metal milk cans beneath the ghetto rubble for posterity.* [✓] [✗]

12. ►►► **They were forced to manage administration and draw deportation lists hoping to save lives** — *Leaders like Adam Czerniaków chose suicide rather than sign orders sending ghetto children to Treblinka extermination camp.* [✓] [✗]

ENQUIRY 3: BARBAROSSA & EINSATZGRUPPEN

13. ► **The German invasion of the Soviet Union, launched as a war of racial annihilation** — *Hitler ordered the total destruction of "Judeo-Bolshevism", initiating the systematic mass murder of entire Jewish communities.* [✓] [✗]

14. ► **Four mobile SS and police paramilitary death squads tasked with executing Jewish civilians** — *Commanded by educated SS officers, Einsatzgruppen A, B, C, and D murdered over 1.5 million men, women, and children in open-air massacres.* [✓] [✗]

15. ►► **SS units and local auxiliaries shot 33,771 Jewish residents of Kiev in 48 hours** — *Victims were marched into the ravine in small groups and gunned down layer upon layer in one of the largest single massacres of the war.* [✓] [✗]

16. ►► **Because shootings were deemed too slow, costly in bullets, and psychologically straining on the SS** — *Himmler sought an impersonal, mechanized method using carbon monoxide exhaust in sealed vans at Chelmno, paving the way for death camps.* [✓] [✗]

17. ►►► **They assisted by identifying Jewish neighbours, guarding roundups, and carrying out executions** — *In Lithuania, Latvia, and Ukraine, nationalist auxiliaries collaborated with small SS detachments, enabling the rapid destruction of entire shtetls.* [✓] [✗]

18. ►►► **It marked the shift from territorial expulsion plans to total systematic annihilation of all Jews** — *With Soviet territory invaded, Nazi leadership abandoned deportation fantasies, committing to total European extermination.* [✓] [✗]

Department Marking Bank • Part 2

Green-Pen Verification Key • Enquiries 4 to 5 (Questions 19 to 30)

ENQUIRIES 4–5

ENQUIRY 4: FINAL SOLUTION & RESISTANCE

19. To coordinate government ministries and the SS in executing the "Final Solution" — *In a 90-minute meeting in Berlin, 15 top civil servants coordinated rail logistics, slave labour, and industrial murder for 11 million European Jews.* ► [✓] [X]

20. Belzec, Sobibor, and Treblinka, built purely as death factories with gas chambers — *Unlike Auschwitz, these camps had no labour selection; arriving transports of men, women, and children were murdered within two hours of arrival.* ► [✓] [X]

21. Prisoners underwent "selection" on the rail ramp for immediate gas chamber death or slave labour — *Those deemed fit were tattooed and worked to death by German corporations; children, mothers, and the elderly were sent straight to Zyklon B chambers.* ►► [✓] [X]

22. Young Jewish fighters held off heavily armed SS troops for nearly a month with pistols and Molotov cocktails — *Led by Mordechai Anielewicz, fighters knew victory was impossible but chose to die fighting with honour rather than board cattle cars to Treblinka.* ►► [✓] [X]

23. By stealing weapons from SS armouries, setting fire to gas installations, and storming fences — *In October 1943 at Sobibor, prisoners killed 11 SS guards, leading hundreds to escape into the forests and forcing the camp's permanent closure.* ►►► [✓] [X]

24. A forest community in Belarus that rescued over 1,200 Jewish women, children, and elderly — *Tuvia and Zus Bielski prioritized saving Jewish lives over combat, building an underground village with schools, hospital, and workshops.* ►►► [✓] [X]

ENQUIRY 5: RESCUERS, LIBERATION & LEGACY

25. Righteous Among the Nations (Hasidei Umot HaOlam) — *Honourees like Raoul Wallenberg, Oskar Schindler, and Chiune Sugihara forged visas and hid children from the SS at extreme personal risk.* ► [✓] [X]

26. To prevent advancing Allied troops from liberating living eyewitnesses to the death camps — *Prisoners were marched through freezing snow without food; guards shot anyone who collapsed, killing up to 250,000 victims before the war ended.* ► [✓] [X]

27. Thousands of unburied corpses and 60,000 starving prisoners dying from raging typhus epidemics — *British medical teams fought to save lives, while newsreel broadcasts by Richard Dimbleby shocked the global public with proof of Nazi barbarism.* ►► [✓] [X]

28. Approximately 6 million Jewish people, representing two-thirds of European Jewry — *Entire communities, distinct languages, centuries of heritage, and 1.5 million children were permanently erased from the European continent.* ►► [✓] [X]

29. Leaders could be prosecuted for "Crimes Against Humanity" and could not claim "only following orders" — *The International Military Tribunal convicted top Nazi leaders, proving sovereign states do not possess absolute immunity to murder civilians.* ►►► [✓] [X]

30. Raphael Lemkin, defining coordinated destruction of a national, ethnic, or religious group — *Lemkin lost 49 family members in the Holocaust and campaigned relentlessly until the United Nations adopted the 1948 Genocide Convention.* ►►► [✓] [X]

UNIT CONCEPTUAL FOUNDATIONS • 4 CORE ANCHORS

THE SHOAH (HOLOCAUST): The systematic, state-sponsored genocide of six million Jewish people across Europe by the Nazi regime and collaborators.

RACIAL ANTISEMITISM: Nazi pseudo-scientific ideology defining Jewish people not by religious belief, but as an unalterable biological racial threat.

EINSATZGRUPPEN: Mobile SS and police paramilitary death squads carrying out the mass open-air murder of over 1.5 million Jews in the East.

RIGHTEOUS AMONG NATIONS: Honorific title bestowed by Yad Vashem on non-Jewish rescuers who risked their lives to save Jews from extermination.